

# Matthias Florian Sahli


**Postdoctoral Researcher**

Bern University of Applied Sciences, Business School

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## SUMMARY


Postdoctoral researcher at the Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH) Business School, previously an economist at the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) of the United Nations and at the Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property — seven years of applied economics outside the university sector; PhD in Economics, University of Neuchâtel (2023). I work on the economics of intellectual property, innovation, digitization and the creative industries, building new datasets and running rigorous econometric analyses to inform policy.


## ACADEMIC POSITIONS

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|---|---|
| 2024 – present | **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)** · Business School, Bern, Switzerland<br>Postdoctoral Researcher |

## EDUCATION

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|---|---|
| 2025 – 2026 | **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)** · Bern, Switzerland<br>Certificate in Higher Education Teaching (Hochschuldidaktik) |
| 2019 – 2023 | **University of Neuchâtel** · Neuchâtel, Switzerland<br>PhD in Economics |
| 2016 – 2019 | **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland<br>MSc in Economics |
| 2012 – 2016 | **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland<br>BSc in Economics, minor in Political Sciences |
| 2006 – 2011 | **Gymnasium Hofwil & Schule für Gestaltung Bern** · Münchenbuchsee, Switzerland<br>Matura; talent promotion class in fine arts |

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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|---|---|
| 2019 – 2024 | **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), United Nations** · Department for Economics and Data Analytics, Geneva, Switzerland<br>Economist and researcher — PhD Research Fellow (2019–2023), then Postdoctoral Research Fellow (2023–2024) |
| 2017 – 2019 | **Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property (IPI)** · Bern, Switzerland<br>Economist, Office of the Chief Economist — internship (2017–2018), then Junior Economist (2018–2019) |

## RESEARCH

| 20 | 76 | 4 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|
| publications & papers | citations | h-index | peer-reviewed venues |

*Source: Google Scholar, retrieved 2026-10-27.*

### PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Digital Reuse and Online Availability of Visual Artworks**
  M. Sahli, A. Cuntz & P. J. Heald · *Information Economics and Policy* · 2026 · 11 citations
- **Does the Digitalization of the Book Industry Reduce Its Environmental Impact?**
  M. Sahli, J. Bieser et al. · *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption* · 2026 · 1 citation

- **Evaluating the Sustainability of National Libraries: A Life Cycle Sustainability Assessment**
  J. Chenoweth, J. Bieser, M. Day, N. Ilott, M Lin, J. Love, M. Martens, R. Murphy, M Nepfer, M. Pennock, U. Pottgiesser, M. Sahli, O. Sievi, and J. Suckling · *Accepted at npj Heritage Science* · 2026
- **Is There a Premium for Legacy Artists? The Death Effect in Exhibition Shows and Auction Transactions**
  M. Sahli & A. Cuntz · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2025 · 4 citations
- **Sustainability in Context: An Evidence-based (Digital) Preservation Lifecycle Investigation**
  M. Pennock, M. Sahli & J. Chenoweth · *iPRES 2025, Wellington* · 2025 · 2 citations
- **Million Dollar Baby — A Primer on Film Finance Practices in the U.S. Movie Industry**
  A. Cuntz, A. Muscarnera, P. C. Oguguo & M. Sahli · *Industry & Innovation* · 2024 · 15 citations
- **Intermediary Liability and Trade in Follow-on Innovation**
  A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2023 · 20 citations

UNDER REVIEW

- **From Digitization to Diffusion: Evidence on the Economic Value of Open Cultural Heritage in the Generative AI**
  R&R AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
  M. Sahli, J. Bieser, J. Chenoweth, J. Suckling, J. Love, E. Lin, M. Martens, M. Pennock & U. Pottgiesser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Gender Gaps in Museum Exhibitions and Art Auctions: Evidence from Linked Exhibition and Auction Records**
  UNDER REVIEW AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
  L. J. Noll & M. Sahli · *ACEI Working Paper Series* · 2026 · 3 citations
- **Open by Design: Open Distribution as a Strategic Choice for Cultural Organizations**
  UNDER REVIEW AT PUBLIC MONEY & MANAGEMENT
  M. Sahli, E. Bertacchini & J. Bieser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Elvis' Ghost or Digital Replica? Publicity Rights and Integrated IP Strategy**
  UNDER REVIEW AT STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT JOURNAL
  A. Cuntz, B. Lutes & M. Sahli · *WIPO Economic Working Paper No. 89* · 2025 · 1 citation

## TEACHING

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| 2026 – | **HES-SO — Haute École de Gestion Genève**<br>· Economics of Innovation (guest lecturer) |
| 2025 – | **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH), Business School**<br>· Entrepreneurial Law (Master), lecturer and module coordination ★ 5.5 / 6<br>· Digitalrecht (Bachelor), lecturer ★ 5.25 / 6<br>· Data Literacy (continuing education), lecturer<br>· Lecture Series SDG1 (Bachelor), lecturer |
| 2025 | **EPFL, College of Management**<br>· MGT-404 Management of Intellectual Property (Master) ★ 1.24 / 4<br>1 = best possible score |
| ongoing | **Supervision of Student Theses**<br>· Supervision of bachelor's and master's theses, practice projects and applied R&D projects |

## GRANTS & AWARDS

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| 2026 | Swisscom study — "From Data to Action: Do Digital GHG Management Tools Drive Real-World Emission Reductions?" (CHF 32,409) |
| 2021 | Best Paper Award, Young Researchers Workshop, 21st International Conference on Cultural Economics, Lille (USD 500) |
| 2020 | Travel grant for the study visit at Copenhagen Business School — Commission de Recherche FNS / Fonds des Donations, University of Neuchâtel |

## RESEARCH INTERESTS & SKILLS

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| Interests | Intellectual property · economics of innovation · industrial organization · economic policy · applied econometrics · creative industries · art markets · sustainability · digitization |
| Languages | Swiss German (native) · German · English · French |

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| Software | Stata · R · Python (basics) · LaTeX · web crawling |